Development Bank, held in Fortaleza in 2002, was another event that local social movements protested against.

This time, civil society was led by the World March of Women, the Landless People's Movement, the union federations CUT and CSP-Conlutas, Jubilee South, the Organisation of Brazilian Women, the Popular World Cup Committee, the Brazilian Network for the Integration of People, in addition to local organisations such as Instituto Terramar, Research and Advisory Centre, and collectives of media, women and youth. Representatives of movements and NGOs from Africa, South America, Europe, Asia and the USA also participated. There were leaders from communities affected by mining in South Africa, academics and NGOs from China and India, as well as large international NGOs such as ActionAid. Support came especially from Germany's Heinrich Boell Foundation (which provided two days of debate on the new BRICS bank, bringing together academics and activists from China, India and South Africa) and the Friedrich Ebert Foundation, as well as ActionAid. Brazilians were obviously in the majority, but we could also feel a great presence from South Africans, a lesser presence of Chinese and Indians and, regrettably, almost no Russian activists.

The topics under debate varied widely: socio-environmental conflicts and inequalities, extraction, criminalisation of social movements, social participation, human rights and transnational corporations, in addition to the central theme of the official summit, infrastructure and the New Development Bank (NDB). For this session, Ambassador Carlos Cozendey, the representative of the Brazilian government's foreign ministry in NDB negotiations, entered into a dialogue with movements and NGOs.

It is important to remember that Fortaleza was preceded by the meeting of social movements and organisations in Durban, South Africa, in 2013, which was called 'BRICS from below'. This was sponsored by the Centre for Civil Society at the University of KwaZulu-Natal, the South Durban Community Environmental Alliance and the NGO groundWork. It brought together grassroots social movements, NGOs and academics. Between Durban and Fortaleza, however, there were very few moments of articulation between the social bases of the BRICS countries. Indeed, a 'BRICS from below' concept is a very recent process and its pace is slower than that of governments and business. The social realities in each country differ greatly, and language remains a problem (the common language is English, but it is inaccessible to communities and grassroots movements outside India or South Africa). What is understood as 'civil society' (a concept that applies to business, if we follow the category of